

Animations, you can do things like make your logo fly in from the left, make typewriter sounds, and have letters appear on screen as if they are being types... just about anything is possible, depending on how much patience you have and how good you are at storyboarding and animating.

You need to remember, however, that a little too much animation will distract from the content and might even become a little irritating. Plus, you have to worry about making your presentation look professional, and not something some school-kid made. Custom Animations gives you the power, but with great power comes great responsibility—use the force, Luke, but do so wisely!

3.5.2.1 Adding Custom Animations

You can add animations by clicking on Custom Animation in the Task pane, then selecting the object you want to animate. Now click Add, and choose an animation. There are many options available and you can add several animations one after the other. Right-click an animation and select whether you want it to Start On Click, Start With Previous, or Start After Previous. This means that you choose whether you want the animation to wait for a click before it happens, start at the same time as the previous animation, or occur automatically after the last animation—you can choose how long after the previous animation the current one will occur.

3.5.2.2 Advanced Effects

If you look at the Custom Animation options, you will notice a button titled [...] in the Effect options next to the Property dropdown that is greyed out by default. Clicking on [...] will open the Effect Options box. Here, you'll see two or three tabs (depending on whether you're animating a text box or another object) called Effect, Timing, and Text Animation.

Under the Effect tab, you can select directions, sounds to play, whether to animate the text as one whole set, word by word, or even letter by letter. You can also change the direction of the ani-